Preliminary Findings:
What We Heard in Rightsizing Engagements

Executive Summary

This memo is a summary of public feedback on the proposed rightsizing scenarios. It covers community input gathered between October 6th and October 28th, 2026. These findings should be treated as preliminary; additional reports will be shared as engagement efforts continue.

Feedback on rightsizing is shared in two ways: a community feedback survey (translated into all PPS-supported languages) and community engagement sessions. As of October 28th, PPS has received 3241 survey responses from community members. The Family and Community Engagement team has also hosted 14 public engagement sessions.

This preliminary report is based on survey responses and community engagement events that took place between October 6th and October 28th.

Five themes emerged:

- **Something must be done:** Community members understand the district's structural deficit and enrollment decline, and many agree that under-resourced schools harm instruction. However, families ask that central office overhead and executive salaries be cut before neighborhood classrooms are closed.
- **Neighborhood schools as community pillars:** Respondents ranked strong neighborhood schools as their highest priority, emphasizing that local campuses act as community hubs. They want to preserve walkability/bikeability and vital after-school care like SUN programs.
- **Skepticism of data and demand for transparency:** Families expressed distrust in enrollment projections, citing past forecasting errors and uncounted local housing developments. Stakeholders want to see independent demographic audits and transparent financial models.
- **Clarity about the student experience:** Before decisions are finalized, families want clear frameworks outlining school-level staffing, yellow bus routes, safe street crossings, and room-by-room special education facility audits.
- **Concerns about Spanish DLI consolidation:** Moving Dual Language Immersion into single-site campuses raises major fears regarding student isolation, reduced heritage-language seats, long travel distances, and ICE safety risks for parents and students.

Tensions and tradeoffs associated with rightsizing also emerged. Families are actively weighing trade-offs between neighborhood schools versus focus option programs, small K–8 settings versus comprehensive middle school electives, union seniority rules versus retaining newer teachers of color, and systemic closures on Portland’s eastside versus travel hazards on the westside.

Preliminary Findings:
What We Heard in Rightsizing Engagements

The purpose of this report is to present a preliminary analysis of community feedback about Portland Public School's rightsizing process. This report serves two purposes. First, it exists to provide transparency and serve as an active listening tool to reflect back what we are hearing from community members regarding the rightsizing process. Additionally, it provides a comprehensive summary of what we have heard from community members between October 6-28, 2026, which can provide guidance for PPS Leadership and the Board of Education as decisions are made regarding rightsizing.

Synthesizing What We Heard: Process and Analytic Methods

Throughout the month of October, there have been two primary pathways for collecting community voice: a feedback survey and community engagement events. The survey is available in all PPS-supported languages, and asks community members to give feedback on rightsizing, rate scenarios against the guiding principles, and provide insight into the tradeoffs involved in rightsizing. Respondents are also given the opportunity to respond to open-ended questions to share their perspectives. The district hosted community-specific (e.g., Black/African American families, Spanish speaking families, Native families, etc.) engagement events as well as general listening sessions (e.g., Board Community Connections).

These two forms of engagement are designed to complement one another. Surveys are wide-reaching and can accommodate a larger volume of feedback. Community engagement sessions create space for people to come together in affinity spaces to share feedback and ask questions. Culturally specific community engagement sessions (specifically for Black/African American families, Native families, Latino/a/e families, and Disability Voices) were created to hear directly from communities that have historically been underrepresented in surveys. PPS' Equity Lens calls us to prioritize the outcomes of focal student groups (Native, Black, multilingual, special education, low-income), and these culturally and community-specific engagements are designed to support that priority.

All community feedback, from the survey as well as community engagement sessions, are analyzed by members of the Data and Accountability department. Responses are reviewed individually, and then deductively coded to align with the Guiding Principles established by Resolution 7307. Next, responses are analyzed inductively, looking for themes, concerns, and questions emerging from community responses. Evidence supporting and challenging all themes are reviewed, as are counternarratives that may arise. Additionally, concerns that may not be repeated frequently but do warrant follow up (e.g., "What will happen to food pantry infrastructure that has been installed in schools that are slated to close?").

Emerging Themes

Across the community engagement sessions and responses to the Rightsizing Scenario Feedback Survey, five clear themes emerged. Below, we describe each theme in detail.

Something must be done

Despite widespread pushback against specific scenario details, community members broadly recognize the district's underlying financial reality and long-term enrollment decline. Parents, educators, and community leaders acknowledge that maintaining small, under-resourced campuses has already diminished the student experience by reducing student's ability to engage with art, music, physical

education, counselors, and reading interventionists. Families see the real impacts of recent budget cuts on daily instruction and agree that status-quo operations cannot continue, but they urge the district to exhaust central administrative cuts before closing neighborhood classrooms

Neighborhood schools are community pillars

Across the district, respondents ranked strong neighborhood schools as their highest priority among the school board's guiding principles, with many families viewing local schools as irreplaceable community hubs. Community members emphasize that neighborhood schools preserve local history, foster multi-grade relationships, and protect connections with trusted educators. Walkability is also a central concern, as parents worry that closing neighborhood campuses forces young children onto busy streets and lengthy bus rides. Beyond daily logistics, families associate the loss of neighborhood schools with a diminished sense of physical and emotional safety, and worry that removing a local school strips neighborhoods of community assets like SUN after-school care and local volunteers.

Data skepticism and the demand for transparency

Community members express skepticism regarding the enrollment forecasts and financial metrics used to justify the proposed rightsizing scenarios. Survey respondents and meeting attendees repeatedly challenge the accuracy of Portland State University's (PSU) demographic models, pointing to historical forecasting errors and noting that projections fail to account for upcoming housing developments. Families criticize the criteria used to evaluate school viability and demand independent demographic audits, transparent data dashboards, and clear proof of central office administrative spending cuts before neighborhood schools face closure.

Clarity and the student experience

Participants across all stakeholder groups emphasize that they cannot evaluate rightsizing proposals without seeing comprehensive and concrete operational plans. Families want clear frameworks detailing school-level staffing allocations, bus routes, traffic studies, and safe street crossing infrastructure for routes crossing major corridors or river bridges. Furthermore, parents ask for explicit menus of support that outline how receiving schools will handle transition trauma, preserve special education pullout spaces, and maintain full after-school childcare capacity.

Concerns about Spanish DLI consolidation

Proposed consolidations of Dual Language Immersion (DLI) programs raise significant concerns regarding equity, access, safety, and commute burdens. While the district frames whole-school DLI models as a way to optimize bilingual staffing and resources, Latino/a/e families and immersion educators worry that centralizing programs will isolate native Spanish speakers and reduce heritage-language seats. Working parents without private transportation warn that long commutes will force them to pull their children out of immersion pathways, while families share fears that cross-city transit heightens exposure to federal immigration enforcement (ICE).

Tensions and Tradeoffs in Rightsizing

Analysis of community input also provides insight into the tensions and tradeoffs that families are facing when making hard decisions about rightsizing schools. Tension exists between centering neighborhood schools and maintaining specialized choice programs. In survey data, 67% of affected respondents feel the proposed scenarios over-emphasize choice programs at the expense of foundational neighborhood schools. At the same time, families enrolled in focus options defend their specialized models. These families emphasize that alternative educational approaches provide a sense of belonging, hands-on

learning, and sensory safety nets for neurodivergent and marginalized students that traditional neighborhood schools cannot replicate.

Additionally, community feedback highlights conflicting perspectives on school size and programmatic access. Some parents of upper-elementary students celebrate the prospect of moving from K–8 facilities into larger, comprehensive middle schools where children can access broader electives, sports teams, and specialized academic tracks. Conversely, other families mourn the potential loss of small school environments, sharing that intimate campus settings foster strong multi-grade relationships, predictable routines, and necessary social-emotional stability for vulnerable learners.

Discussions on building consolidations surface questions regarding workforce and equity. Collective bargaining provisions with the Portland Association of Teachers (PAT) rely heavily on seniority for staff reassignments during school closures. However, Black, Native, and Latino/a/e families raise concerns that strict adherence to seniority rules will displace educators of color and bilingual teachers who serve as mentors for historically underserved students. This would create a direct conflict between contractual procedures and district equity commitments.

Finally, distinct regional narratives are emerging, illustrating competing definitions of equity and risk across the district. Black, Native, and Latino/a/e families in North, Northeast, and Southeast Portland emphasize that historically marginalized, lower-income communities bear a disproportionate share of school closures, boundary shifts, and neighborhood disruptions compared to protected Westside campuses. Meanwhile, Westside families argue that their region's steep topography, winding roads, traffic congestion, and river bridge crossings create severe physical hazards for student transit.

Summary and Conclusion

This overview of emerging themes across all engagement types reveals questions, priorities, and tensions that are emerging through the community engagement process. Next, we provide more in-depth analysis of the feedback received from each track of the engagement process specifically.

First, we present findings and emerging themes from the feedback survey, which show specific insights revealed through quantitative and qualitative analyses of survey data. After, we present emerging themes from community engagement sessions, which provide more specific insights into culturally and community specific engagement groups.

Data Deep Dive:
Rightsizing Feedback Survey

Survey Methods

A community survey, translated into English, Simplified Chinese, Spanish, Somali, Russian, and Vietnamese, was released alongside rightsizing scenario proposals. As of October 28th, we have received 3,241 responses from parents/guardians, PPS staff, students, and community members representing all of our school communities. About 94% of respondents represented school communities affected by the rightsizing scenario proposals in some way, including school closure, school consolidation, program changes, or boundary changes. Survey responses have been collected in English, Spanish, Russian, and Simplified Chinese. Surveys are also available in Somali and Vietnamese, but these languages have not received any responses. While this survey was only available digitally, members of some school communities printed out paper copies of the survey and distributed it to families before supporting with data entry.

See Tables 1-3 for a breakdown of respondent demographics, and see Appendix A for counts of responses by school as of October 28th. Please note: not all counts will total the number of responses received; all questions are optional, and demographics were multi-select to represent the intersectional identities of our community. See Appendix B for a list of the questions asked on this community Survey.

Table 1:
Percentage of Respondents Representing Community Roles

Community Group	# of Respondents	% Of Respondents
Parent/Guardian	2716	74%
Student	176	5%
Staff/Educator	305	8%
Community Member	475	13%

Table 2:
Percentage of Respondents with Students Receiving Services

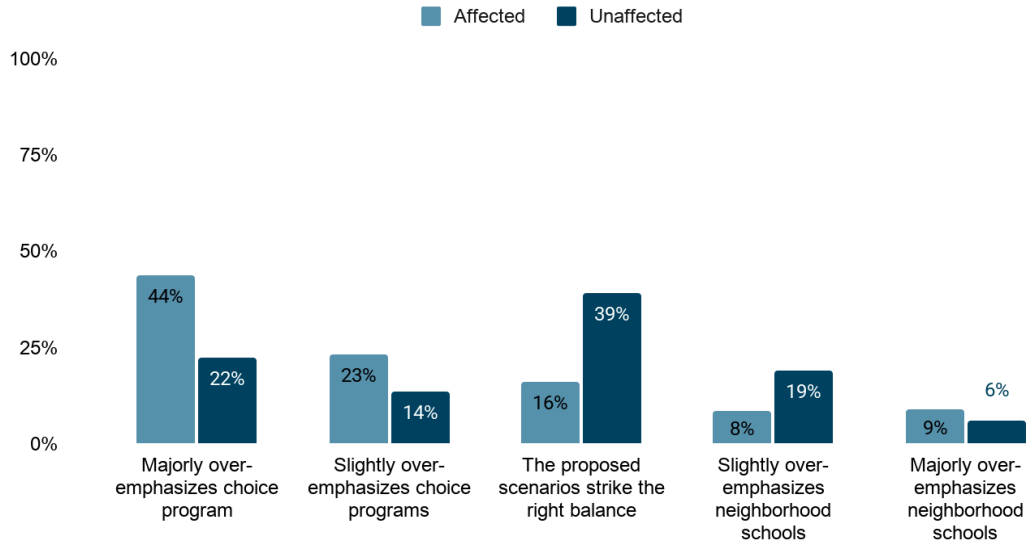
Services Received	# of Respondents	% Of Respondents
Special Education	636	20%
Multilingual Learner Services	49	2%
Dual Language Immersion	452	15%
Talented and Gifted	686	22%
None of the above/Prefer not to say	1291	41%

Table 3:
Percentage of Respondents by Race/Ethnicity

Race/Ethnicity of Respondents	# of Respondents	% Of Respondents
Asian	163	5%
Black/African American	89	3%
Latino/a/e	256	7%
American Indian/Alaskan Native	50	1%
Native Hawaiian/Pacific Islander	11	<1%
White	2173	64%
Multi-Racial	241	7%
Prefer Not to Say	433	13%

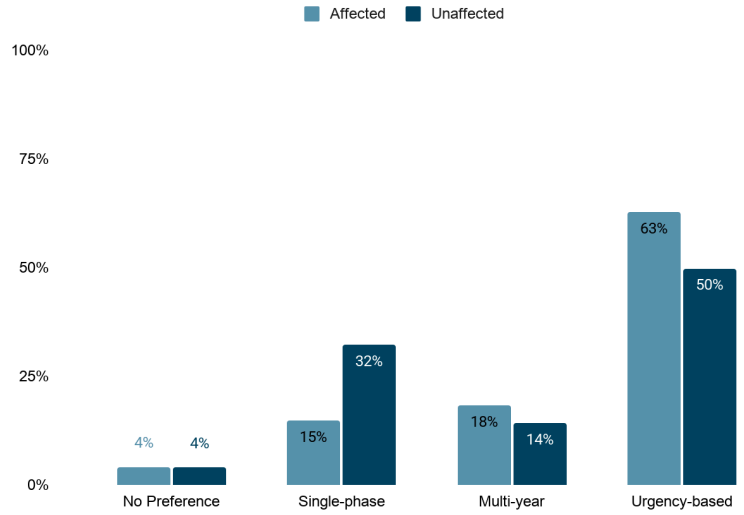
Survey Response Analysis
Below, we present the results for close-ended questions regarding rightsizing preferences, disaggregated by whether or not a respondent is directly affected by the proposed scenarios or not. Affected schools include any building facing a closure, a boundary change, or a programming change.

Resolution 7307 says that neighborhood schools are the foundation of the system when balancing access to choice programs. How well do the proposed scenarios balance those two needs? (n = 2572)



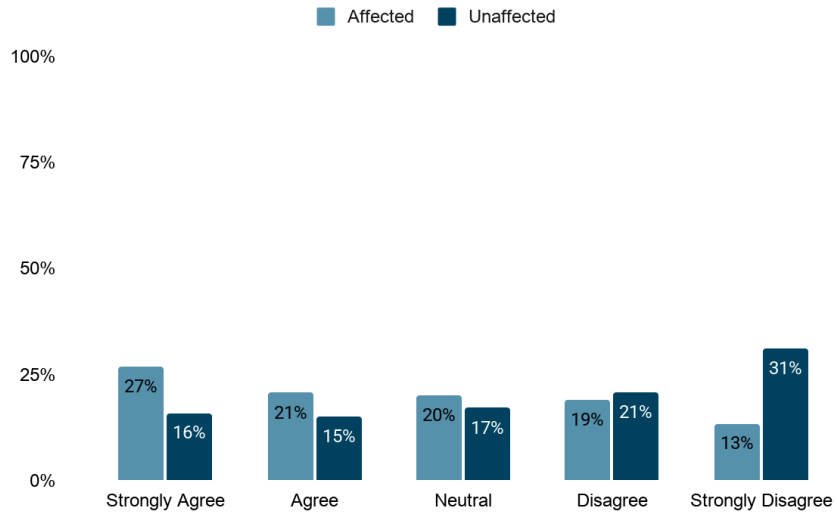
Taken together, over half of affected respondents think that the proposed scenarios over-emphasize programs of choice.

Rightsizing involves a trade-off between how large changes are and how often they occur. Which approach best aligns with your priorities? (n = 2901)



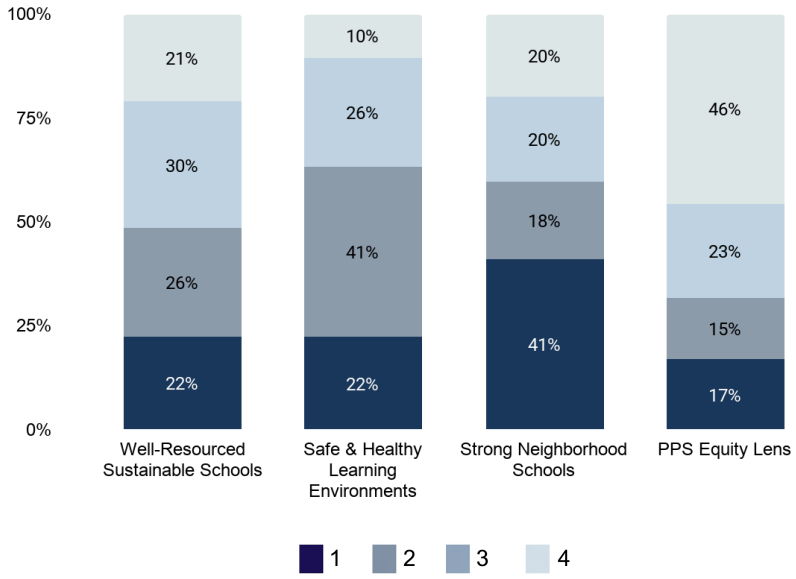
The majority of both affected and unaffected respondents urge the district to use an urgency-based approach to sequence rightsizing implementation decisions.

How much do you agree with this statement? "I am willing to accept a larger near-term adjustment (e.g., boundary change or closure) if it guarantees my school will not face further rightsizing for at least 5 years." (n = 2954)



There is no clear preference for whether respondents would prefer a larger near-term boundary change to prevent further rightsizing in Portland Public Schools.

Please rank the Board's adopted Guiding Principles in order of importance to your family where 1 = Highest Priority (n = 2,879)



Generally, respondents ranked Strong Neighborhood Schools as most important, Safe and Healthy Learning Environments as second, Well-Resourced Sustainable Schools as third, and the PPS Equity Lens as last.

Open-Ended Response Analysis

The survey asked the following open-ended questions:

- What specific support (e.g., transportation to school, students staying with their classmates) would you need if school changes occur all at once instead of over several years? (n = 2,250)
- What specific resources or help should the district provide to support schools affected by rightsizing? (n = 2,122)
- Our goal is to create a model that is fair and equitable to all communities. Did we miss any important equity issues, community history, or student needs in creating these models? If yes, please tell us what we missed and how we can address it. (n = 2,150)
- What is one thing you would like us to know about your school community? (n = 2,484)

Below, we present a thematic analysis of the open-ended responses. First, we present an analysis that was coded deductively using the Guiding Principles established by Resolution 7307 before sharing feedback on key topics that emerged and a regional deep dive.

Alignment with the Guiding Principles

Well-Resourced, Sustainable Schools. Community members agree that every school needs full-time teachers, art, music, physical education, counselors, and support staff. However, families express skepticism that closing buildings will actually guarantee these resources in receiving schools. Parents point out that past district budget cuts stripped away specialists and paraprofessionals, making them worry that consolidated schools will simply become larger and more crowded without receiving extra staff or better academic programs. To trust this principle, families need transparent, itemized staffing plans and clear proof that central office administrative overhead is being reduced before classroom resources are touched.

Safe & Healthy Learning Environments. Families emphasize physical building safety, emotional stability, and facility quality. Community members stress that receiving schools must have modern infrastructure, including working HVAC and air conditioning, seismic upgrades, up-to-date classroom technology, and safe, accessible playgrounds. Beyond physical structures, parents highlight the need for mental health support, full-time counselors, and dedicated transition specialists to help students process the emotional stress of losing their familiar school environments. For neurodivergent students and children with Individualized Education Programs (IEPs), safe environments also mean preserving quiet sensory spaces, predictable routines, and physical accessibility like ramps and elevators.

Strong Neighborhood Schools. Respondents expressed civic and emotional attachment to their local neighborhood schools, describing them as essential community hubs that tie neighborhoods together. Parents worry that closing neighborhood schools damages local vitality, divides tight-knit communities across multiple attendance boundaries, and eliminates walkability. Families emphasize that neighborhood schools foster multi-grade relationships, volunteer networks, and local after-school programs like SUN care. Many community members urge the district to view neighborhood schools as irreplaceable assets worth protecting, suggesting boundary adjustments and community mergers rather than outright school closures.

PPS Equity Lens. Feedback regarding equity reveals major concerns about an uneven burden falling on low-income, Title I, and historically marginalized communities, particularly in North and Northeast Portland. Families question why diverse schools face frequent boundary shifts, closures, and program moves while wealthier Westside campuses appear protected. Additionally, respondents worry that redrawing boundaries will strip receiving schools of their Title I status, taking away essential reading specialists and student services. Parents of Special Education students, English language learners, and immigrant families emphasize that true equity requires protecting vulnerable learners from repeated system disruptions and providing dedicated support during any transition.

Emerging Hot Topics

Dual Language Immersion (DLI). Community feedback on Dual Language Immersion reflects a tension between program sustainability and neighborhood access. While some families understand the district's goal of consolidating DLI into full-building campus models to guarantee full-time bilingual staff and resources, many parents express alarm over proposed program moves. Families worry that centralizing DLI programs will isolate native language speakers, cause racial segregation, and force long travel distances that working families cannot maintain. Parents of native Spanish and Mandarin speakers demand clear safety plans, preserved heritage-language seats, and guaranteed transportation so that DLI programs remain accessible to the communities they were created to serve.

K-8 Schools and Focus Options. Families connected to K–8 schools and focus options, such as Sunnyside Environmental School, Creative Science, and the Metropolitan Learning Center, strongly oppose removing middle grades or dismantling their unique models. Parents and students explain that K–8 continuity provides emotional stability, reduces disciplinary issues, and offers crucial sensory safety nets for neurodivergent learners during difficult middle school transitions. Community members emphasize that hands-on, alternative, and environmental learning environments cannot be replicated in large comprehensive middle schools. Families urge the district to preserve these focus options and learn from their successful practices rather than closing or shrinking them.

Transportation and Traveling to School. Transportation is one of the most urgent concerns raised across all survey responses. Families express widespread alarm over losing walkable and bikeable neighborhood routes, pointing out that proposed changes will force young children onto long bus rides or multi-transfer public transit trips. Parents raise serious safety concerns regarding dangerous high-speed street crossings, major traffic bottlenecks, and geographic hazards like mountain road closures and river bridge crossings. Working parents emphasize that guaranteed district busing, crossing guards, and safe bike routes are non-negotiable requirements if school boundaries are redrawn.

Building Capacity, Physical Accessibility, and Dedicated Spaces. Families raise serious concerns about how receiving school capacity is calculated for special education. Parents and staff point out that special education requires dedicated spaces for sensory regulation, speech therapy, behavioral de-escalation, and pullout instruction. If these rooms are treated as standard classrooms in building capacity models, it would misrepresent available space. Additionally, parents highlight physical accessibility barriers in older receiving buildings, noting that missing elevators, ramps, and secure perimeters create safety and mobility risks for students with physical disabilities or elopement concerns.

Deaf and Hard of Hearing (D/HH) & CRIS Program at Creston. A prominent theme in Southeast Portland involves the Columbia Regional Inclusive Services (CRIS) Deaf and Hard of Hearing (D/HH) program hosted at Creston Elementary. For over 20 years, Creston has built a deeply integrated, inclusive culture where D/HH students learn alongside their hearing peers. Parents and staff express strong alarm over scenario proposals that move the D/HH program away from Creston to align with middle school feeder paths at Mt. Tabor. Families argue that separating D/HH students from their long-time hearing classmates and experienced general education teachers breaks apart a supportive community fabric. Community members demand that D/HH students remain with their Creston peers, and suggest offering American Sign Language (ASL) classes to all students and staff at receiving sites.

Intensive Skills Classrooms (ISC) and Staffing Ratios. Families with students in Intensive Skills Classrooms (ISC) and self-contained programs express fear over program relocations and staffing

shortages. Parents point out that recent district budget cuts have already reduced educational assistants and paraprofessionals. Families worry that moving ISC programs to new sites without guaranteed staffing ratios will overwhelm teachers and leave high-needs students without adequate one-on-one support.

Regional Deep Dive

North Region

Feedback from the North region (Jefferson and Roosevelt cluster) strongly focuses on racial equity, historical community impact, and Dual Language Immersion programs. Nearly a third of comments (32%) urged the district to protect Spanish Dual Language Immersion programs from being split up or shut down. Community members cited North Portland's history of gentrification, displacement, and past school closures, warning the district not to place an unfair burden on Black, Brown, and low-income families. Responses also stressed the need to preserve Title I wraparound services, free meal programs, and culturally responsive staff who reflect the student body.

Northeast Region

In the Northeast region (Grant and McDaniel cluster), families talked about teacher retention and keeping academic tracks intact. Almost a third of respondents urged the district to keep experienced teachers and support staff in place rather than making budget cuts or frequent staff reassignments. Parents also expressed strong concern about Dual Language Immersion pathways so students do not drop out mid-way through their education. Finally, responses highlighted the need to rebalance boundaries between overcrowded facilities and under-enrolled neighboring schools without breaking apart cohesive neighborhood communities.

Southeast Region

In the Southeast region (Cleveland and Franklin cluster), community feedback centers heavily on middle school transitions, feeder patterns, and student traffic safety. Over a quarter of comments from this region specifically focused on the shift between K-8 schools and standalone middle schools. Parents emphasized that younger students will need dedicated yellow bus service and crossing guards if forced to cross busy roads like Powell, 82nd, and Division Streets. Keeping student cohorts and friend groups together was another top priority, as parents worry that splitting kids up across different schools will hurt their social and emotional well-being.

West Region

In the West region (Ida B. Wells and Lincoln cluster), community concerns centered on aging school buildings and geographic barriers. Almost a third of families discussed facility conditions, like lack of air conditioning, seismic safety concerns, and of space in receiving schools. Because Westside neighborhoods feature steep hills, winding roads, and very few sidewalks, parents stressed that walking to school is unsafe and that district-provided busing will be necessary. Families in this cluster also expressed the highest level of distrust toward district enrollment figures, demanding raw data and financial transparency before any closures occur.

Data Deep Dive:
Emerging Themes from Community Engagements

Between October 6-28, Portland Public Schools' Family and Community Engagement Department hosted engagement sessions to gather public feedback on the proposed rightsizing scenarios. These meetings included regional town halls in North, Southeast, West, and Northeast Portland, targeted sessions for Native and Black families, Board of Education Community Connections, virtual forums, and Village Table discussions. Hundreds of parents, students, educators, and community members participated across these events to review scenario options, ask questions, and share how proposed changes would impact their schools and neighborhoods.

Here, we present major themes that emerged from these engagement sessions. First, we present general themes before diving into specific stakeholder groups. Follow the links below to view the summaries of each engagement session:

Engagement Event	Number of Participants
The Village Table (October 14)	82
Community Voice: Special Education Families (October 15)	44
Board of Education Community Connection (Oct 17)	102
Latino/a/e Community Conversation (October 19)	37
Black/African American Community Conversation (October 22)	23
School Impact: North Region (October 24)	103
School Impact: Southeast Region (October 24)	235
School Impact: West Region (October 24)	213
Native Community Conversation (October 26)	25
Community Connection (October 27)	76
Community Connection (October 28)	69

There is an Educator Town Hall Scheduled for October 29, 2026. A summary of that engagement event will be included in the final report.

Emerging Themes Across All Stakeholder Groups
Community members across every region questioned the enrollment models used by the district, pointing out past errors in small-area forecasting and census data. Parents worried that projections are failing to account for new housing developments or recent enrollment stability in feeder schools.

Families also expressed concern over losing walkable and bikeable neighborhood schools. Parents highlighted severe transit barriers, including dangerous street crossings, long bus rides, mountain road closures, traffic backups on Germantown Road, and hazards across the St. Johns Bridge.

Many community members emphasized that closing small schools or K–8 focus options removes sensory accommodations, elevators, and predictable routines for students with Individualized Education Programs (IEPs). Moving high-needs students into larger, busier middle schools threatens their emotional and academic stability. However this belief was not universally held; some parents/guardians communicated that they were hopeful that their 6-8 grade students would have additional learning opportunities at a comprehensive middle school.

Families were concerned that shifting attendance boundaries could drop receiving schools below federal Title I eligibility thresholds, stripping away reading specialists, support staff, and community resources. Working parents also stressed that guaranteed after-school care (SUN programs and fee-based childcare) is essential.

Community members expressed mixed views on centralizing DLI into full-building campus models. While consolidated programs offer full-time bilingual staff and resources, families worry that pulling DLI out of neighborhood schools creates racial and language isolation. Moreover, parents warned that moving DLI programs long distances may force working families to leave the program.

Finally, participants consistently argued that the district must cut central office administrative overhead and salaries before closing neighborhood schools or cutting classroom staff.

Feedback from Native Family Engagements
Native families who attended this engagement session strongly urged the district and the teacher's union to ensure seniority rules do not push out impactful BIPOC teachers and underrepresented staff during school mergers. Similarly, Native community members expressed frustration over executive pay raises during a budget crisis, calling for cuts to central office salaries to support students.

Native families also raised concerns that digital surveys and other forms of communication disproportionately represent white households and leave out community members without technology.

Feedback from Black/African American Family Engagements
Black families who attended this engagement session raised concerns that low-income and historically marginalized schools in East and Northeast Portland face a disproportionate share of closures and program moves compared to protected Westside campuses. Participants emphasized that school consolidations must intentionally protect Black cultural hubs and community connections in North and Northeast Portland. Additionally, Black parents and community members expressed concern regarding staff of color during school closures and mergers. Specifically, many Black families worry that strict union

seniority rules will force out newer, highly effective, teachers of color who serve as vital mentors for Black students.

Furthermore, Black leaders and parents expressed frustration with non-minority residents for misusing terms like "redlining," "segregation," and "busing" to describe boundary changes. Similarly, Black community members expressed frustration with the false narratives circulating that equate Black student populations with Special Education programs, demanding public clarification from district leadership. These families expressed that discourse about rightsizing is harming Black students and families.

Feedback from Latino/a/e Family Engagements

Much of the feedback from Latino/a/e families centered on the consolidation of Dual Language Immersion (DLI) programs. Families expressed strong pride in Spanish DLI programs but worried that relocating programs across town will isolate students or force parents to drop out of immersion education. Working parents emphasized that long travel distances to reallocated programs would create severe daily commute challenges for families without private transportation. Families noted that federal immigration enforcement (ICE) activity in local neighborhoods has directly driven enrollment drops by forcing immigrant families to relocate or stay home.

Additionally, Latino/a/e parents who attended this engagement session highlighted that many Spanish-speaking families face significant language barriers, lack access to digital updates, or feel uncomfortable attending large public meetings. They expressed frustration about the way they were engaged broadly.

Summary and Conclusions

Community feedback shared in engagement sessions shows that families understand the district's financial situation, but they want decisions that protect neighborhood schools and keep kids safe. Across town halls and regional meetings, parents agree that school changes should not create dangerous commutes, hurt special education services, or weaken dual language programs. People also expect district leaders to cut central office spending and administrative salaries before closing any neighborhood classrooms.

Conversations with Native, Black, and Latino/a/e families show that equity requires action. This includes protecting Black and Native cultural hubs, improving engagement outreach for non-English speakers, and working with labor partners to protect teachers of color from seniority layoffs. Black leaders also called out residents who misuse terms like redlining and busing to protect their own school boundaries.

Appendix A: Count of Responses By School to Date.

***Note**: Some respondents represent multiple school communities*

School Name	# of Responses
Abernethy E.S.	53
ACCESS K-8	60
Ainsworth E.S.	25
Alameda E.S.	47
Alliance	15
Arleta E.S.	28
Astor K-8	34
Atkinson E.S.	69
Beach E.S.	74
Beaumont M.S.	63
Benson Polytechnic H.S.	49
Beverly Cleary K-8	92
Boise-Eliot/Humboldt E.S.	18
Brentwood M.S.	28
Bridger Creative Science School	49
Bridlemile E.S.	42
Buckman E.S.	45
Capitol Hill E.S.	27
Cesar Chavez K-8	38
Chapman E.S.	14
Chief Joseph E.S.	29
Clark E.S.	38
Cleveland H.S.	284
Creston E.S.	125
DaVinci Arts M.S.	45
Dr Martin Luther King Jr E.S.	46
Duniway E.S.	174
Faubion PK-8	38
Forest Park E.S.	23
Franklin H.S.	92
George M.S.	33

Glencoe E.S.	26
Grant H.S.	165
Grout E.S.	36
Harriet Tubman M.S.	64
Harrison Park M.S.	35
Hayhurst E.S.	32
Hosford M.S.	89
Ida B Wells-Barnett H.S.	110
Irvington E.S.	111
Jackson M.S.	117
James John E.S.	245
Jefferson H.S.	47
Kellogg M.S.	39
Kelly E.S.	11
Laurelhurst K-8	110
Lent E.S.	11
Leodis V McDaniel H.S.	49
Lewis E.S.	103
Lincoln H.S.	76
Llewellyn E.S.	160
Maplewood E.S.	169
Markham E.S.	34
Marysville E.S.	41
Metropolitan Learning Center	44
Mt Tabor M.S.	41
Ockley Green M.S.	61
Odyssey Program K-8	24
Peninsula E.S.	70
Pioneer	11
Reconnection Center	7
Richmond E.S.	32
Rieke E.S.	34
Rigler E.S.	34
Robert Gray M.S.	43
Roosevelt H.S.	62
Rosa Parks E.S.	14

Rose City Park E.S.	96
Roseway Heights M.S.	46
Sabin E.S.	113
Scott E.S.	64
Sellwood M.S.	412
Sitton E.S.	86
Skyline K-8	43
Stephenson E.S.	227
Sunnyside Environmental K-8	199
Sunrise E.S.	11
Vernon K-8	73
Vestal E.S.	21
West Sylvan M.S.	37
Whitman E.S.	26
Winterhaven K-8	31
Woodlawn E.S.	16
Woodmere E.S.	35
Woodstock E.S.	59
Grand Total	**5749**

Appendix B: Rightsizing Scenario Feedback Survey Items

Thank you for sharing your perspective as we plan for the future of Portland Public Schools. We are currently weighing potential scenarios for our rightsizing efforts. Your feedback will directly influence the final recommendations presented to the School Board.

Section 1: About You
We are collecting demographic information to ensure that we are hearing from all communities and that our final decision does not disproportionately impact historically underserved students and families.

What is your relationship to PPS? Please select all that apply.
- Parent / Guardian
- Student
- Staff / Educator
- Community Member
- Other: _____

Which school(s) are you connected to?
- *[Drop-down list of school sites]*

Does your student(s) receive any of the following services? (Select all that apply)
- Special Education (SPED/504)
- Multilingual Learner Services (MLL)
- Dual Language Immersion (DLI)
- Talented and Gifted (TAG)
- None of the above / Prefer not to say

Does your student(s) currently attend a focus option or alternative program?
- Yes
- No
- I don't know

How do you identify your race or ethnicity? (Select all that apply)
- Asian
- Black or African American
- Hispanic or Latino/a/x
- Native American / Alaska Native
- Native Hawaiian / Pacific Islander
- White
- Multi-Racial
- Prefer to self-describe: _____
- Prefer not to say

What engagement session did you attend?
- [Drop down with titles and dates; included a "none of the above" option]

Section 2: Guiding Principles: Alignment and Trade-Offs
In May of 2026, the Portland Public Schools Board of Education adopted a resolution that outlined the guiding principles they would use when making decisions about rightsizing. This document also stated that the board would center neighborhood schools, engage the community, and create an implementation plan that will minimize disruption to students, staff, and families. The guiding principles are:

Guiding Principles			
Well-Resourced Schools Sustainable, well-resourced schools that provide consistent access to strong academic programming across PPS.	**Safe and Healthy Learning Environments** Aligning school facilities and learning environments to support student safety, wellness, and long-term sustainability.	**Educational Options** Maintaining a strong network of neighborhood schools (while providing a balance of educational options) that are sustainable and well-resourced.	**PPS Equity Lens** Using the PPS Equity Lens to guide decision-making and center students most impacted by inequities.

Below, we ask questions about the district's proposal for rightsizing and the guiding principles.

Please rank the Board's adopted Guiding Principles in order of importance to your family (1 = Highest Priority):

- Well-Resourced Sustainable Schools: Ensuring rich programming that is buffered from enrollment shifts.
- Safe & Healthy Learning Environments: Prioritizing facility viability, safe routes, and walkability.
- Strong Neighborhood Schools: Centering neighborhood schools as the foundational model.
- PPS Equity Lens: Prioritizing outcomes for focal student groups (Native, Black, multilingual, special education, low-income).

Resolution 7307 establishes neighborhood schools as the foundation of the system while balancing access to choice programs. How well do the proposed scenarios balance those two needs?

- Majorly over-emphasizes neighborhood schools
- Slightly over-emphasizes neighborhood schools
- The proposed scenarios strike the right balance
- Slightly over-emphasizes choice programs
- Majorly over-emphasizes choice program

Rightsizing involves a trade-off between how large the changes are and how often they occur. Which approach best aligns with your priorities?

- *Option A:* Single-phase rollout — Implement all school/program consolidations in one school year to resolve uncertainty quickly.
- *Option B:* Multi-year phased approach — Spread consolidations over two years to allow families and staff more transition time.
- *Option C:* Urgency-based sequencing — Address schools with severe enrollment drops or facility needs first, phasing remaining changes later.
- No Preference

How much do you agree with this statement? I am willing to accept a larger near-term adjustment (e.g., boundary change or closure) if it guarantees my school will not face further rightsizing for at least 5 years.

- Strongly Agree
- Agree
- Neutral
- Disagree

- Strongly Disagree

What specific support (e.g., transportation to school, students staying with their classmates) would you need if school changes occur all at once versus phased over several years?

The Portland Public Schools Student Assignment Policy asks us to consider the following six factors, and we recognize that there will be tradeoffs when making decisions about rightsizing. Please select the three most important factors to consider during program and enrollment balancing across our system.

- Right Pathways: A feeder pattern that allows as many students as possible to continue together from one school level to the next
- Right Mix of Students: Student body demographics
- Right Boundaries: Compact boundaries that promote safer routes to schools and a sense of community as well as recognize and address natural and human-made barriers
- Right use of Space: Optimal use of existing facilities
- Right Balance: Program and enrollment stability in the surrounding schools
- Right Impact: Limiting the impact of boundary changes to the smallest number of students possible

Section 3: Open-Ended Feedback

What specific resources or help should the district provide to support schools affected by rightsizing?

Our goal is to create a model that is fair and equitable to all communities. Did we miss any important equity issues, community history, or student needs in creating these models? If yes, please tell us what we missed and how we can address it.

What is one thing you would like us to know about your school community?

Section 4: Communications Check In

District leaders want to understand whether the information shared with our community about rightsizing is effective. Please answer the following questions about your experience with presentations, announcements, and other engagements about the rightsizing process.

I understand why the district is considering these changes.

- Strongly Agree
- Agree
- Neutral
- Disagree
- Strongly Disagree

I trust the information the district is providing.

- Strongly Agree
- Agree
- Neutral
- Disagree
- Strongly Disagree

I believe my voice can make a difference in this process.

- Strongly Agree
- Agree
- Neutral
- Disagree
- Strongly Disagree

I understand how decisions will be made.

- Strongly Agree
- Agree
- Neutral
- Disagree
- Strongly Disagree

I feel the district understands community concerns.

- Strongly Agree
- Agree
- Neutral
- Disagree
- Strongly Disagree

Appendix C: Village Table Summary
October 14, 2026

Meeting Purpose
This meeting of the Village Table was a place for members to learn more about why PPS developed the Rightsizing scenarios and how the proposed changes are intended to support well-resourced schools and equitable learning opportunities for students. Village Table members also learned more about how the proposed scenarios could impact regions and school communities, and how to communicate these changes accurately and thoughtfully with families.

Number of Participants: 82

Community Insights (What Resonated?)

Theme 1: "Well Resourced Schools" vs. the Loss of Resources	Village Table representatives shared that recent cuts have already stripped schools of paras, IB programs, music, and specialists. Some members shared that this reality helps them understand that school consolidations must be done, but many worry that larger schools without guaranteed staffing will mean more students, lost community partner spaces (SUN, RESJ, Childcare), and strains on other resources (auditoriums, playgrounds, cafeterias, etc.) without an increase in instructional quality. Village Table members want to see plans for how these considerations are going to be addressed before a decision is made. Additionally, some community members shared that some slated changes seem positive; for example, parents of soon-to-be 6th graders appreciate the opportunity to transition from a K-8 to a traditional middle school in order to access electives.
Theme 2: Protect Vulnerable Learners	Village Table representatives worried that big transitions will affect Special Education students, neurodivergent learners, and those in self-contained/focus classrooms. Moving students with high sensory or mobility needs into buildings without clear plans for physical accessibility (elevators/ADA), classroom capacity, elopement safety, or transition support threatens students' well-being.
Theme 3: Concerns about DLI	Some representatives voiced concern that centralizing Dual Language Immersion programs will isolate students and unintentionally segregate schools. Families want to understand why dual language immersion campus models are being recommended, and how students and families will be affected. Additionally, some community members want to see detailed safety plans to protect families from ICE and other threats to community safety when making longer commutes to school.
Theme 4: More Data and More Detail	Village Table members want to know more about how scenarios were built, what data was used, and what the plan is overall. Representatives feel information is withheld or delivered to the media before families, leaving them to act as unpaid "ambassadors" for

	incomplete plans without seeing their feedback reflected back. Overall, Village Table members want more information.
Theme 5: Closure vs. Consolidation	Especially in the North region, Village Table members were curious about how proposed school closures could be mergers instead of closures. Members want to know how school culture and staff will live on in new buildings, and how teachers across consolidations will be affected.

Opportunities

- District leaders have the opportunity to shift the narrative and administrative process from closing schools to merging two schools. By intentionally integrating school cultures, staff, traditions, and names, PPS can honor community history and lessen transition trauma.
- Village Table Members encourage PPS staff to build a unified, public data dashboard containing audited facility costs, enrollment projection methodologies, DLI metrics, and staffing models.
- The district can pioneer robust transition protocols specifically tailored for SPED, neurodivergent, and DLI students—including transition days, physical facility retrofits, and dedicated spaces for community partners (SUN, RESJ, Childcare).
- Village Table members want this space to be used for two-way communication - instead of just making comments and identifying questions, members want meetings to be a space where district representatives can provide transparent answers.

Questions for District Leadership

- How will staffing allocations, seniority, and reassignments operate under existing PAT contracts during closures vs. mergers, and on what exact timeline will staff and families see school-level staffing plans?
- What specific instructional and operational metrics define a "well-resourced school," and how will PPS guarantee that increased school size translates into better teaching and support rather than just higher student density and lost elective/para support?
- How has the district accounted for physical accessibility (elevators/ADA), classroom capacity, sensory needs, and elopement/safety protections for SPED focus classroom students being moved to receiving schools?
- How will PPS mitigate the loss of Title I funding at specific schools (e.g., Markham, Brentwood), prevent DLI consolidation from creating racial isolation?
- How was the decision made to consolidate DLI programs into campuses? And if this proposal is moved forward, what safety plans will be in place to protect vulnerable students and families?
- If rightsizing moves forward, there will be schools remaining that have enrollment below the identified thresholds due to geographic isolation and other factors. Will they be left vulnerable for future rightsizing? How will these buildings be served/will they also be well-resourced?

Appendix D: Community Voice: Disability Voices Summary
October 15, 2026

Location: Kellogg Middle School
Number of community members in attendance: 44

What We Heard

Some families that attended this session expressed that K-8 schools can offer a supportive environment for neurodivergent students. These parents shared that K-8s can help keep special education students in public schools, even if district data shows similar academic results between K-8 and 6-8 models overall. While some acknowledge that K-8 teachers handle heavy workloads, parents value the strong community culture and effective special education support these schools provide.

Parents involved in the Disability Voices community want clear information about future staffing levels, funding, and class sizes. Many disagree with the idea that larger schools are better, noting that crowded classrooms overstimulate neurodivergent children. Families are asking for specific student-to-teacher ratios, and want information about staffing numbers right away. Without concrete details on support staff, parents find it difficult to trust the proposed changes.

Families worry that building plans focus heavily on square footage and building age rather than actual accessibility and the physical needs of the communities served by a building. They noted that buildings like Creston feature specialized equipment, including acoustic carpeting and emergency deaf reader boards. Parents want to know if receiving schools will match these essential physical accommodations. Additionally, parents are concerned that moving the Columbia Regional Deaf and Hard of Hearing program away from Creston will disrupt a closely integrated community. Moving the program to a new location would require retraining new staff because all staff in the building support the students in this program, not just the program-specific educators.

Questions Raised

- How are students and staff being engaged and included in this process?
- Will receiving school buildings have the same physical accommodations and trained staff?
- What will staffing levels, special education support, and class sizes actually look like?

Appendix E: Board of Education Community Connection Summary
October 17, 2026

Location: McDaniel High School
Number of Attendees: 102

What We Heard

In this Community Connection, many attendees acknowledged that the district is facing a structural deficit and declining enrollment, and agreed that systemic changes are necessary. However, many attendees expressed that the timeline is a barrier to feeling ready for a decision. Participants want more transparency in how the proposed scenarios came to be and expressed the desire to evaluate multiple alternatives.

Some families expressed concern about how Special Education and neurodivergent students are included in the proposed scenarios. Some expressed that the needs of students receiving special education services were "treated as an afterthought." Moving high-needs students into larger schools may threaten their physical and emotional stability. Additionally, some participants expressed concern that the proposed shifts to Dual Language Immersion (DLI) programs create unfair barriers for immigrant families and students of color. Relocating or splitting DLI programs forces working parents to choose between cultural education and local neighborhood access.

Still others expressed concern regarding commuting to school. Redrawing boundaries sometimes disrupts walkability and may require multiple bus transfers that strain parents without personal transportation. Additionally, merging campuses threatens to strip Title 1 funding from sites, while leaving vacant buildings in neighborhood hubs. Instead of rushing to close schools by December, some community members want the district to explore state rainy-day funds and build a clearer implementation model that proves it will not harm the students who need support the most.

Questions Raised

- What specific data and facility trade-offs justify closing or moving individual schools?
- How will the district protect Special Education (SPED) students from overcrowding and loss of services?
- How will the district address the commuter burdens placed on working families?
- Are there examples of other districts where school closures at this scale improved student outcomes?
- How will the district prevent vulnerable schools from losing Title 1 funding when boundaries change?

Appendix F: Latino/a/e Community Conversation Summary
October 19, 2026

Location: Hosford Middle School & Virtual
Number of Attendees: 20 in personal 17 virtual

What We Heard

Many of the Latino/a/e community members in attendance opposed PPS's proposed school closures and Dual Language Immersion (DLI) consolidations. Speakers stressed that moving neighborhood DLI programs into consolidated single-site schools may segregate learning environments, expose undocumented families to immigration enforcement, and place heavy commute burdens on working parents.

Participants want more information about why this decision was made. Some asked for research and evidence that whole-school DLI models are as effective or better for students' academic and social development than having co-located programs.

Families were also concerned that there has not been enough engagement with the Latino/a/e community broadly, wanting more opportunities to respond and be engaged about changes, especially those that affect the Spanish-language DLI program.

Questions Raised

- Is there research or data that shows that whole-school Dual Language Immersion programs have equal or better academic or social outcomes than co-located neighborhood programs?
- What transportation and safety plans exist to address bus rides, hazardous driving corridors, and winter travel?
- What protective measures will PPS implement to ensure undocumented parents and extended family members are not exposed to ICE during school drop-offs and pick-ups?
- Will consolidating Dual Language Immersion programs reduce the overall number of seats available for native Spanish speakers, and what will the ratio of native speakers to neighborhood students be at receiving schools?
- Why are program changes happening now instead of making gradual adjustments?

Appendix G: Black/African American Community Conversation Summary
October 22, 2026

Location: McDaniel High School
Number of Attendees: 23

What We Heard

This memo summarizes the feedback, questions, and district responses from the Black and African American family engagement session held on October 22, 2026. The meeting was designed as a direct, open dialogue between Black families and Portland Public Schools (PPS) leaders, including Superintendent Dr. Armstrong, Board Members Michelle DePass and Virginia La Forte, and district leaders Nichole Watson, Dr. Kelli Charles, and Dr. Angela Freeman.

In this engagement session, community members and district leaders talked about harmful language and assumptions about Black Portlanders that are being used by other communities during Rightsizing discussions. Black leaders and parents expressed concerns that other community members are using words like "redlining," "segregation," and "busing" to describe proposed boundary changes. Similarly, parents raised concerns about claims that lump all Black students together with Special Education students. Participants in this conversation talked about the racism and equity detours being used in anti-rightsizing conversations, and how these perspectives are harmful to Black students.

Families also discussed proposed changes to specific schools and programs. Concerns were raised about changes at Irvington, Scott, Rigler, and Sabin, while participants appreciated plans that protect Black cultural hubs in North and Northeast Portland at King, Boise, and Tubman, emphasizing that preserving Black culture must remain a priority during school mergers.

Families asked questions about how staffing will be handled in school mergers, and specifically around retaining staff of color during these transitions. Similarly, families wanted to know more about how the district will bring together students from different backgrounds while ensuring that Black students feel safety and a sense of belonging in their school community.

Questions Raised:

- How will staff relocation decisions be made, and will effective, newer teachers of color be pushed out of schools under union seniority rules?
- How will this rightsizing process repair historical harm or improve academic outcomes for Black students, especially when past district restructurings failed to do so?

Appendix H: School Impact: North Region Engagement Summary
October 24, 2026

Location: Jefferson High School
Number of Attendees: 103

What We Heard

This memo summarizes the feedback, themes, and questions raised during the session for affected families in North Portland, serving the Jefferson and Roosevelt school clusters.

Families expressed deep concern over losing walkable and bikeable neighborhood schools. Parents noted that proposed changes would increase some student commutes from seven blocks to seven miles. Families want to see clear busing routes, safe street crossings, and transit support for long travel distances. Additionally, attendees asked for clear data showing projected cost savings, building repair expenses, and racial demographic shifts at receiving schools. Many felt the decision timeline was too rushed and urged the district to phase in changes over two to three years.

Parents raised concerns about moving Dual Language Immersion (DLI) programs. Families worry about larger class sizes, splitting siblings between different schools, and racial isolation. Additionally, community members described neighborhood schools, like James John, as essential community hubs. Closures would directly impact local youth programs, reduce local volunteer involvement, and harm nearby small businesses and community infrastructure.

While most speakers opposed closures, some participants noted that keeping small, under-resourced schools open also harms students by limiting staff, electives, and academic support. Other parents suggested combining school communities equally rather than framing decisions as one school closing into another.

Questions Raised

- How will the district support families whose commutes will increase from a few walkable blocks to several miles under the proposed scenarios?
- What are the exact racial demographic shifts for receiving schools like Cesar Chavez and George Middle School, and will these program moves increase segregation?
- How will students with IEPs or physical disabilities be supported when leaving accessible buildings, and what proof exists that moving students to new schools will improve academic results?

Appendix I: School Impact: Southeast Region Engagement Summary
October 24, 2026

Location: Cleveland High School at Marshall Campus
Number of Attendees: 235

What We Heard

Many families in the Southeast region spoke about K-8 focus option programs. Students and parents advocated for K–8 focus options including Sunnyside Environmental School and Bridger Creative Science. Speakers emphasized that K–8 continuity provides routine, opportunities for outdoor learning, and sensory accommodations for neurodivergent students and children with Individualized Education Plans (IEPs). Families worry that students in middle grades that transfer to large comprehensive middle schools will lose these support structures.

Community members that attended this session questioned the enrollment models and capacity calculations used in the rightsizing decision making process. In particular, speakers pointed to historical errors in small-area forecasting and census data. Parents expressed concern that receiving schools will face overcrowded hallways, cafeteria rushes, and Spanish DLI classes.

Families from schools like Woodmere, Whitman, Brentwood, and Creston raised alarms about losing Title I federal funding if school boundary changes alter local poverty percentages. Parents worry that losing Title I status would mean losing support staff, reading specialists, and community resources that serve low-income, multilingual, and trauma-impacted students.

Finally, participants advocated for the district to cut central office administrative overhead before closing schools. Community members requested itemized cost data, public proof of compliance with Equity Policy 7307, and room-by-room space audits. Many urged the board to pause the process, partner with state lawmakers on education funding, or adjust boundaries rather than closing established schools.

Questions Raised

- Why is the district closing strong middle schools like Sellwood and removing middle grades from Sunnyside K–8 when receiving schools like Hosford already have large classes?
- How accurate are the enrollment forecasts the district is using?
- How will the district protect access, heritage-language seats, and transportation for multilingual families in Spanish and Mandarin DLI programs?

Appendix J: School Impact: West Region Engagement Summary
October 24, 2026

Location: Ida B. Wells High School
Number of Attendees: 213

What We Heard

Community members in attendance frequently challenged the enrollment projections used by the district. Specifically, speakers talked about upcoming housing developments, such as the Alpenrose site, expressing concern that projections fail to account for incoming families. Concerns were also raised that absorbing new students into Markham could drop its poverty percentage below the Title I funding threshold. Generally, speakers frequently voiced support for their own schools while also acknowledging the district's enrollment and budget challenges.

West Side families highlighted commuter concerns, including major traffic backups on Germantown Road, snow closures, and travel delays across the St. Johns Bridge. In particular, Skyline parents raised safety concerns about high schoolers driving to Roosevelt across the bridge, especially during emergencies or earthquakes. Additionally, families from Maplewood and Stephenson expressed fear over losing walkable neighborhood options and being split across multiple schools.

Additionally, some families defended the Metropolitan Learning Center (MLC) 9-12 program. Parents and students explained that MLC's small school environment provides critical safety, belonging, and academic success for neurodivergent, special education, and transgender students who struggle in traditional high schools.

Finally, community members asked district leaders to engage in active listening by explicitly sharing how public input is changing their thinking.

Questions Raised

- What is the definition of a "well-resourced and sustainable school" beyond baseline enrollment targets?
- When will families see concrete staffing plans for the proposed scenarios?
- How will the district ensure safe, timely access for Skyline students assigned to Roosevelt across the St. Johns Bridge?
- How is public feedback actually changing leaderships' thinking about the Rightsizing process?

Appendix K: Native Community Conversation Summary
October 26, 2026

Location: Barbie's Village
Number of Attendees: 25 in person

What We Heard

In this engagement session, native community members raised concerns about how rightsizing and union contract rules will affect educators of color when schools are closed or merged. Families reminded the district that only considering seniority could push out talented and committed BIPOC teachers and staff. Parents pushed district leaders and the Portland Association of Teachers (PAT) to prioritize retaining educators of color.

Additionally, attendees voiced frustration over the superintendent's absence from the meeting and expressed fatigue over years of district feedback processes that led to little action. Families pointed out that online QR-code surveys are an important start, but this feedback disproportionately represents white families. Online-only surveys leave out community members who do not have access to technology. Native community members offered to partner with the district to host in-person feedback sessions in order to increase participation.

Community members offered financial solutions to address the district's budget deficit, specifically asking for cuts to central office administrative salaries. Participants expressed frustration over the superintendent's recent pay raise, and advocated for reviewing administrative compensation and redirecting funds to support students.

Finally, native families advocated for the district to repurpose a closing school building as a permanent facility and community center for Native and Indian Education programs. Participants emphasized that rightsizing creates an opportunity to provide Native students and families with a lasting, dedicated space for cultural and educational services.

Questions Raised

- How will the district protect BIPOC teachers and ensure that union seniority rules do not push out educators of color during school consolidations?
- Is the district considering administrative layoffs and pay cuts?
- What resources will support the Native students affected by rightsizing?

Appendix L: Board of Education Community Connection Summary
October 27, 2026

Location: Lincoln High School
Number of Attendees: 76

What We Heard

This memo summarizes the feedback, key themes, and questions raised during a Board of Education Community Connection, open to all members of the PPS community. Participants included neighborhood parents, DLI families, classroom teachers, school board members, and district leadership.

Attendees questioned the enrollment forecasts used by the district. Speakers pointed out that individual school projections from Portland State University (PSU) have been inaccurate in the past. Attendees call for independent demographic audits, clear financial breakdowns showing central office cuts, and feasibility studies for closed properties before decisions are finalized.

Some parents urged the district to keep intact student cohorts and unique school models together (e.g, Bridger Creative Science and Metropolitan Learning Center). Similarly, some teachers expressed concern and skepticism about the district's ability to provide transition support for schools undergoing rightsizing.

Families from Atkinson and Lent raised concerns about district outreach to Spanish-speaking communities. Parents highlighted that many Latino families face language barriers, lack access to digital updates, or feel unsafe attending large public meetings. Participants talked about the success of Dual Language Immersion (DLI) programs.

Finally, West side families (especially those in the Skyline catchment) shared concerns about commuting to school on the East side. Skyline parents noted mountain road closures, landslides on Newberry Road, fatal crashes on Germantown Road, and heavy traffic on Cornelius Pass. Parents warned that forcing students to travel up to two hours or cross the Willamette River during bad weather or emergencies.

Questions Raised

- How does closing neighborhood schools protect classroom teaching positions, and where do the financial savings actually go?
- How is the district addressing poor engagement with Spanish-speaking families?

Appendix M: Board of Education Community Connection Summary
October 28, 2026

Location: Virtual
Number of Attendees: 69

What We Heard

Parents and community members questioned district enrollment projections, specifically asking why middle schools like Sellwood have forecasted enrollment drops when feeder elementaries appear stable. Community members also expressed concern over receiving school capacity, especially when forecasted capacity is over 100%. Some families raised a concern that long commutes or school closures might cause families with financial means to leave the district.

Community members raised questions about how teacher relocations will work when school communities merge. Educators and parents asked how union seniority rules will affect staffing transfers, and specifically wanted there to be clear plans to protect teachers of color and bilingual educators.

Families raised concerns about receiving schools losing federal Title I funding when absorbing new students. Parents of students with disabilities asked for clear plans on special education pullout spaces and inclusion supports. Working parents also emphasized that after-school care (SUN programs and fee-based childcare) will be essential if commutes increase.

Finally, participants asked for clear timelines regarding when specific operational details will be released. Parents want clear information about bus routes, drop-off logistics, lunch and recess rotation schedules, and room-by-room building layouts before the school board votes on final recommendations.

Questions Raised:

- Why are middle schools like Sellwood projected to drop by 30% when feeder elementary schools currently look stable?
- If absorbing new students causes a receiving school to lose its Title I funding status, how will the district make up for lost staff and student resources?
- Will receiving schools projected over 100% capacity need to use portables? And when schools are at over 100% capacity, how will special education and other pullout spaces be protected?